

A Star Fleet Battles™ Scenario

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(SG____.0) COSMIC PINBALL

A twist on the multi-player duel, this scenario puts commanders in a dynamic environment where their ships become akin to "pinballs", a term derived from a game common in mid-to-late 20th century Earth. The map is populated with "bumper" hexes, each one having a specific effect on player units entering the hex. Units can be stopped in their tracks, displaced, put in stasis, sped up or slowed down. As an added wrinkle, the "bumpers" are usually encircled by terrain.

(SG____.1) **NUMBER OF PLAYERS:** Two or more

(SG____.11) **LIMITS:** Players should agree to limit the number of ships (preferably one and certainly not more than two *per* player), and set a *per*-player BPV cap (probably in the 100 to 200 range).

(SG____.12) **SIMULATORS:** A simulator empire, like the Triaxians, could have advantages.

(SG____.13) **EMPIRES:** Specific empires (such as Orions) and ship-types (such as War Destroyers) may also have advantages due to the ability to customize.

(SG____.2) **INITIAL SETUP:**

TERRAIN: See (SG____.41)

SHIPS: As selected within agreed-upon (SG____.11) limits. Select starting positions by agreement among the players, but before determining the location (SG____.411) of bumpers.

YEAR: Unless otherwise agreed upon by the players, use Y180.

(SG____.3) **LENGTH OF SCENARIO:** Scenario continues until all forces except those of one side have been destroyed or captured/surrendered.

(SG____.4) **SPECIAL RULES:**

(SG____.41) **MAP:** The map is fixed and bounded by a (P17.0)

Tournament Barrier.

(SG____.411): Using (P3.11), locate the bumper hexes; these hexes do not have terrain; exception (SG____.662).

(SG____.412): The (P3.12) hexes surrounding each bumper hex have a randomly-selected terrain. For each bumper hex, roll one die and consult the following table:

1	Asteroids (P3.0)
2	Quiet Nebula (P6.0)
3	Heat Zone (P10.0)
4	Dust Cloud (P13.0)
5	Radiation Zone (P15.0)
6	Empty space

(SG____.413): Units enter the bumper hexes according to the Movement Order (in some cases, the sequence of entry makes a difference).

(SG____.414): The bumper hexes are further described below in (SG____.44).

(SG____.42) **SHUTTLES AND PFS:**

(SG____.421): PFS may be used in this scenario, but each should count as an individual ship. PF Tenders should not be permitted.

(SG____.422): For reasons which should be obvious, fighters

are strongly discouraged, as are special-purpose shuttles such as MRS, MLS, *etc.*

(SG____.43) **COMMANDER'S OPTION ITEMS:**

(SG____.431): Each player may purchase Commanders Options for their ship(s) *per* (S8.0) in amounts agreed upon by the players.

(SG____.432): If players wish to require boarding actions to achieve captures, then they may consider limiting Options to Boarding Parties and relaxing the normal limits on purchases.

(SG____.44) **BUMPER HEXES:**

(SG____.441): Each bumper hex has a randomly-selected effect determined before the start of play; exceptions (SG____.6).

(SG____.442): Roll one die and consult the following table for each bumper hex.

1	Random Facing Change (SG____.451)
2	Displaced (SG____.452)
3	Unit Stops (SG____.453)
4	Stasis (SG____.454)
5	Teleported (SG____.455)
6	Accelerate or decelerate (SG____.456)

(SG____.443): A bumper hex only affects a unit when that unit enters the hex as the result of movement, or when a unit tractored by/tractoring a ship is rotated/moved into the hex.

(SG____.4431): If a unit is forced to move into the bumper hex while tractored/tractoring, it is immediately affected by the bumper.

(SG____.4432): If a unit is rotated (G7.7) into the bumper hex, the bumper does not affect the unit until the INVOLUNTARY MOVEMENT STAGE (6A1) of the MOVEMENT SEGMENT of the first impulse of the turn, as the very first movement event.

(SG____.45) **BUMPER EFFECTS:**

(SG____.451) **Random Facing Change:** Roll one die and change the facing of the unit as indicated (the facing may not actually change if it is already facing the direction matching the roll, but the unit is still affected as if it had).

(SG____.4511): The unit's facing is changed as if it had executed an HET (C6.0). The unit does not have to actually be eligible to perform an HET, nor is an otherwise eligible unit prevented from subsequently performing an HET normally.

(SG____.4512): There is no: energy cost (C6.2), chance of breakdown (C6.5), effect on any HET first-use bonus (C6.52) the unit might have, or movement penalty (F2.131).

(SG____.4513): The Maneuver Rate (C2.42) of the unit is not changed; there is no effect on Turn (C3.2) or Sideslip (C4.1) Modes, which is an exception to (C6.32).

(SG____.452) **Displaced:** The unit is affected as if it had been successfully displaced by an Andromedan Displacement Device (G18.0). There is no chance of failure; roll two dice for distance, one for direction, and ignore (G18.41).

(SG____.4521): The displaced unit has its fire-control affected by (G18.42), but there is no displacing ship to fire at so (G18.421) is ignored. If there is a unit already in the destination

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hex when the unit is displaced, then use (G18.59) to determine relative positions. See also (SG____.644).

(SG____.4522): If the distance of the displacement would result in the unit leaving the map, the distance is reduced by the minimum amount needed to ensure the unit stays on the map (do not alter the direction of displacement).

(SG____.4523): If the unit is displaced into another bumper hex, that bumper does not affect the unit, as it did not enter as the result of movement. See also (SG____.644).

(SG____.453) Unit Stops: Roll two dice; the unit stops moving for that many impulses. Essentially, while under the effects of this bumper, the unit has a Movement Cost of ∞ and an Effective Speed (C2.43) of zero (but that does not completely describe the effect). The effect begins and ends as the last event of the DAMAGE DURING MOVEMENT STAGE (6A3) of the MOVEMENT SEGMENT (6A), and may extend into the next turn; see (SG____.4538) for the effect on speed changes.

(SG____.4531): If the unit is tractorred by a ship, it is treated as if it were a base with Positional Stabilizers (G7.251). The stopped unit is not in stasis; it can still fire and be fired upon. While stopped, it cannot perform an HET or any other movement, dock, perform tactical maneuvers, or use reserve power to move during the stoppage; note this does not prohibit the ship from changing speed, within the limits of other rules, either as already plotted or through the use of reserve power; see (SG____.4538). Any movement that would have taken place during the impulses is lost; any power allocated for that movement is also lost. If a ship had allocated power for an HET and the turn ends before the ship can move, the allocated energy is lost.

(SG____.4532): A stopped unit does not undergo Emergency Deceleration (C8.0); the lost movement energy cannot be used for shield reinforcement. If otherwise eligible, the stopped unit may declare Emergency Deceleration while stopped. The count-down (C8.101) to the maneuver starts normally, but the unit does not actually decelerate until the stoppage ends; a ship using EmDecel under these conditions is able to benefit from (C8.102), but not until the maneuver is completed and then only if completed before the end of the turn.

(SG____.4533): The stoppage does not count as a "speed change" for the purposes of (C12.311) or (C12.312). However, when a cloaked ship is stopped, it does count for the purposes of (G13.332) and may require an enemy to roll for lock-on.

(SG____.4534): If a stopped unit was engaged in Erratic Maneuvering (C10.0), the EM ceases while the unit is stopped. While stopped, an otherwise eligible unit may announce it is ending EM; if at least one impulse elapses between the announcement and the release of the unit, then it will not be using EM when it is released.

(SG____.4535): If a stopped unit was not engaged in Erratic Maneuvering (C10.0), an otherwise eligible unit may announce it is starting EM. It cannot actually use EM until it is able to move. The unit is not required to announce starting use of EM

until the impulse of its release; however, it cannot benefit from EM until the impulse after it is released.

(SG____.4536): Direct fire is unaffected; this includes ADDs and probes fired as weapons; partial exception (SG____.45374). If a seeking weapon targeted on the stopped unit enters the bumper hex, it impacts its target before the bumper can affect the weapon.

(SG____.4537) Effects on Launched Units: If the stopped unit launches any other units, such as drones, plasma torpedoes, shuttles, Hyperdrones (FD55.0) and/or probes (not fired as a weapon), the bumper affects the movement of those units as follows:

(SG____.45371): Drones (except Hyperdrones), plasma torpedoes, shuttles and probes are stopped until the launching unit is eligible to move. The endurance of such weapons is calculated to start when they are launched, not when they are able to move. However, ECM drones and plasmas begin to generate ECM in accordance with their normal rules (they don't have to wait until they are able to move).

(SG____.45372): If a launched unit itself launches other units (for example, a multi-warhead drone, or a scatterpack shuttle), then those units are also stopped until the launching unit is eligible to move.

(SG____.45373): If a seeking weapon is launched and the target of the weapon enters the bumper hex before the launching unit is eligible to move, the seeking weapon cannot impact its target until it is able to move. A seeking weapon capable of direct fire, such as a Swordfish (FD11.0) drone, can only fire at its target if the target is in arc (that is, the weapon cannot turn to engage until it is released).

(SG____.45374): Hyperdrones launched by a stopped ship are affected, but the stoppage does not count as the required pause (FD55.33).

(SG____.4538): If the stoppage extends into the next turn, a ship may use its speed prior to the stoppage when calculating its maximum speed increase (C2.21), but if it does so, then power must be allocated for movement during the time when the ship is still stopped, even if that results in lost power (although there is no requirement that the ship plot for movement at its maximum allowed speed once the stoppage ends). Alternatively, across a turn break, the ship can use a speed of 0 (that is, treat the stoppage as a deceleration to speed 0); in this case, even if the ship reverses direction (C3.5) after less than eight impulses of stoppage, it does not pay a braking cost (C3.52).

EXAMPLES: A ship moving at speed 10 enters the bumper on Impulse #29 and is stopped for seven impulses. The movement that would have occurred on Impulse #32 is lost. The next turn, the captain wants to accelerate; consulting the impulse chart, she sees that while she can plot for speed 20, doing so will cause her ship to lose two movement points

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(on Impulses #2 and #4). She instead plots for speed 12 so her ship only loses one movement point (on Impulse #3) and plots a mid-turn speed change to speed 20 on Impulse #5. Her ship is released and eligible to move after movement on Impulse #4, and moves at speed 20 on Impulse #5.

Another ship, forced by a tractor link, enters the same bumper on Impulse #11 while moving at speed 18, and is stopped for five impulses; the tractoring ship immediately releases the link to avoid being anchored. Normally, the ship in the bumper would lose three movement points (on Impulses #13, #15 and #16); however, the captain had plotted an acceleration to speed 28 on Impulse #12, so it instead loses five movement points (since it would have moved during each Impulse from #12 through #16). When the stoppage ends, the ship is moving at speed 28; for the purposes of (C12.312), it executed its plotted speed change on Impulse #12, not #16 (assuming proper announcements were made). If the ship had been cloaked and an enemy had lost lock-on when it was stopped, the enemy attempting to regain lock-on under (G13.332) would have to wait for Impulse #17, when conditions would change in its favor.

A third ship enters the bumper, moving at speed 23, and is stopped for five impulses on Impulse #30. It loses two movement points (Impulses #31 and #32). During Energy Allocation, the captain decides to reverse direction; he plots for speed 0, followed by a mid-turn speed change to speed 10 on Impulse #5 (since the ship would not move before Impulse #5, there is no lost movement point). He does not pay a braking cost; under the bumper's effects, for the purposes of (C12.37), his ship is treated as if it were at speed 0 for the previous eight impulses.

(SG____.454) Stasis: Roll three dice; the unit is affected as if it had been placed into Stasis (G16.4) for the number of impulses rolled. This effect may extend into the next turn. There is no unit generating the stasis, so nothing can disrupt it.

(SG____.455) Teleported: The unit is instantly teleported to another, randomly-determined, bumper hex. This is not the same as displacement, but PPD wavelock is lost and fire control is disrupted as if by (G18.42). Seeking weapons tracking the teleported unit may lose lock-on, in accordance with their rules; however, if they enter the bumper hex on the same impulse as the teleported unit, they impact their target before it is teleported; additionally, an ECM drone or plasma tracking the teleported unit is also teleported, if it enters the bumper hex at the same time as the unit.

(SG____.4551): The destination bumper hex does not affect the unit, since it did not enter the hex as the result of movement.

(SG____.4552): If another unit enters the destination bumper hex during the same impulse the unit is teleported, then this unit does not change how the destination bumper affects the other unit. See also (SG____.643).

(SG____.4553): If there is a unit already in the destination bumper hex when the unit is teleported, then use (G18.59) to

determine relative positions. See also (SG____.643).

(SG____.4554): The teleportation breaks any tractor beam attached to the teleported unit, and also any tractor links to other ships from a teleported ship; however, any non-ship units (for example, drones and shuttles) held in a tractor by a teleported ship are teleported with it, and remain held unless released by other rules.

(SG____.456) Accelerate or decelerate: Roll two dice; for the remainder of the turn, the unit's speed is enhanced or diminished (randomly determine which) by the amount shown. The unit does not gain or lose any power (essentially, its Movement Cost temporarily changes, but that does not completely describe the effect). Hyperdrones (FD55.0) are not affected since they are treated as direct-fire weapons.

(SG____.4561): This does not count as a "speed change" for the purposes of (C12.311) or (C12.312); however, the Turn Mode (C3.2) of the unit is affected. If a cloaked unit has its speed changed, that does count for the purposes of (G13.33) and may allow/require an enemy to roll for lock-on.

(SG____.4562): If the bumper imparts a speed change that would cause the unit to exceed a speed of 31, the unit only accelerates to 31. Units already moving at speed 31 (or faster) are not accelerated by this bumper (but can be slowed).

(SG____.4563): A unit that would ordinarily be destroyed by an increase imparted by the bumper (for example, a standard admin shuttle that is suddenly moving at speed 13 or more) is not destroyed, but may be destroyed by a speed increase imparted by other means (for example, death-dragging) if the unit would have been destroyed by that speed after subtracting the increase imparted by the bumper from the new speed.

EXAMPLE: A shuttle moving at speed 6 enters this bumper hex and has eight added to its speed. It is now moving at speed 14, but is not destroyed. Before the turn ends, a hostile ship moving at speed 18 tractors the shuttle; the shuttle is still not destroyed ($18 - 8 = 10$). Still during the same turn, the ship changes to speed 22; the shuttle is now death-dragged since the new speed, minus that imparted by the bumper ($22 - 8 = 14$), exceeds the speed at which the shuttle would be destroyed.

(SG____.4564): Speed changes, plotted or otherwise, made by the affected unit are adjusted by the change; the limit of 31 remains no matter what. If a unit is accelerated, then even if it subsequently uses Emergency Deceleration (C8.0), or has plotted for speed 0, it does not stop and therefore cannot use Tactical Maneuvers (C5.0); note that even though the ship would not actually stop if it performed Emergency Deceleration, it would still benefit from (C8.102).

EXAMPLES: A ship, moving at speed 24, enters the bumper on Impulse #16; the die rolls result in an increase of ten, but (SG____.4562) limits the speed increase to seven; after movement, the ship is moving at speed 31. The captain had plotted a speed increase to 26 on Impulse #28; for the purposes of (C12.312), he must announce and execute the

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plotted speed change, although his ship does not actually change speed.

Another ship, moving at speed 4, enters the hex on Impulse #10; the die result is an acceleration of eight, so the ship is immediately moving at speed 12, and moves on Impulse #11. The captain, intending to use Tactical Maneuvers, had plotted for speed 0 on Impulse #15; on Impulse #14, she must announce the speed change, but the ship only slows to speed 8 (and therefore cannot use her planned Tac-Warps).

(SG____.4565): If the affected unit was moving at a speed less than a reduction imposed by this bumper, then it stops; it does not move in reverse. A ship that has its speed reduced (whether it stops or not) by this bumper may use Reserve Warp to overcome (in whole or part) the reduction, and doing so does not count as a "speed change" for the purposes of (C12.311) or (C12.312), but does count for the purposes of (G13.332).

When calculating the Reserve Warp needed, a stopped ship is treated as being at speed 0, even if the reduction in speed was greater than the ship's speed at the time it was stopped.

(SG____.4566): If a unit has its speed changed by this bumper, and (before the turn ends) is affected by (SG____.453), the unit stops. If the unit becomes able to move again before the turn ends, the speed change applied by this bumper remains in effect if its duration has not ended.

(SG____.4567): When calculating its maximum speed increase (C2.21) for the next turn, a ship uses its speed prior to the change imparted by this bumper (along with any subsequent mid-turn speed changes). The effect of this bumper is ignored for the purposes of both (C2.21) and (C3.52).

(SG____.4568): If an affected unit launches anything (such as drones, plasmas, shuttles, *etc*), then the launched unit is affected as follows:

(SG____.45681) If the launching unit is still in the bumper hex, then any launched units are affected in the same manner (that is, apply the exact same effect to the launched unit, do not re-roll for effects).

(SG____.45682) If the launching unit is no longer in the bumper hex, then the launched unit is not affected (unless and until it enters the bumper hex, in which case use the normal process to determine the effects).

(SG____.5) VICTORY CONDITIONS: Use Standard Victory (S2.2).

(SG____.6) VARIATIONS: This scenario can be modified in a number of ways.

(SG____.61) UNKNOWN EFFECTS: Instead of pre-determining the effects of each bumper hex, only roll when the first unit enters the hex. The effect is known by all players thereafter. It is not recommended to mix this variation with (SG____.663).

(SG____.62) DYNAMIC EFFECTS: After each bumper hex is triggered (that is, affects a unit), reroll the effect of the bumper hex, either immediately, or when the next unit enters it (or limit the change so that it

only occurs when another ship, not a non-ship unit, enters the bumper). However, (SG____.4537) takes precedence for units launched by a unit subject to that particular bumper effect. It is not recommended to mix this variation with (SG____.663).

(SG____.63) PLAYER-CONTROLLED EFFECTS: Randomly (secretly or openly) assign each bumper hex to a player (or establish an order in which players get to select unassigned bumper hexes). It is not recommended to mix this variation with (SG____.663).

(SG____.631): Each player assigns (secretly, in writing) the effect of their bumper hex(es). The effect is revealed when any player's unit enters the hex. It is not recommended to mix this variation with (SG____.663).

(SG____.632): Optionally, after a player's unit is affected by a bumper, the "owner" of that bumper assigns (secretly, in writing) a new (but possibly the same) effect to that bumper. Players should decide if a bumper effect can be repeated or if it must be changed, and may also wish to limit the change process to occur only after a ship (and not a non-ship unit) triggers the bumper.

(SG____.633): Regardless of the method by which a bumper's effect might change, (SG____.4537) takes precedence for units launched by a unit subject to that particular effect.

(SG____.64) BUMPER HEX SINGLE OCCUPANCY: Only one ship may occupy a bumper hex at a time.

(SG____.641): This will not prevent a non-ship unit (for example, a seeking weapon) from entering the bumper hex while a ship is in it.

(SG____.642): If the bumper hex is occupied, then any ship attempting to enter **MUST** maneuver to avoid entering the bumper hex. If the normal movement rules for a ship do not allow it to avoid entering the bumper hex, then it side-slips (select which direction randomly) and its side-slip mode is reset. It would also be permissible (but not required) for the ship outside the bumper hex to, if not prohibited by other rules, use a tractor beam to force the ship inside the bumper hex out (or prevent itself from moving and being forced to side-slip). The ship in the bumper hex, if eligible, could also do that, but is not required to do so (nor is a ship in the bumper required to prevent or allow another ship to tractor it).

(SG____.643): Under this variation, when randomly selecting the destination hex for (SG____.455), exclude from consideration any bumper hex already occupied by a ship.

(SG____.644): Also under this variation, if a ship is displaced by (SG____.452) and is indicated to land in a bumper hex already occupied by another ship, then select a random adjacent hex instead.

(SG____.65) NO TERRAIN: Instead of randomly determining (SG____.412) the Terrain around each bumper, use Empty Space for all of them.

(SG____.66) OTHER EFFECTS: Players may wish to explore other possible bumper effects, either in addition to those listed in (SG____.42), or as substitutions:

(SG____.661) No Effect: Entering the bumper does nothing to the unit. This can be interesting if combined with (SG____.61)

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and/or (SG____.63).

(SG____.662) Rebound: The unit is immediately moved into a random hex adjacent to the bumper, as if it had moved into that hex normally instead (imagine the bumper hex is a frictionless hemisphere and the unit “slides off”; the unit may “slide back” into the hex from which it moved). Facing does not change, nor are Turn or Sideslip Modes affected. Each unit entering during an impulse is individually affected (thus, a seeking weapon that would have, under normal circumstances, hit its target might be moved into an entirely different adjacent hex and forced to chase the target down again; this includes ECM drones/plasmas). If the bumper hex is on the map edge, then any off-map adjacent hexes are excluded. If players control effects (SG____.63), then this may be a way to define an effect for excess bumpers (those that cannot be evenly distributed to players).

(SG____.663) Black Hole: The bumper hex itself is a Black Hole (P4.0). All units entering the hex are immediately affected, regardless of if they entered it as the result of movement (an exception to (SG____.443)); however, it does not cause (P4.1) involuntary movement. Direct-fire cannot pass through the bumper hex, but there is no EW effect (P4.24). Essentially, the effects of the Black Hole are entirely contained within the bumper hex, so (G7.75) is ignored (this bumper could make a handy “seeking weapon dispose-all”, and certainly would be dangerous for someone on the losing end of a tractor auction).

(SG____.664) Advantage: The bumper hex contains a mechanism by which the ship gains some advantage. This variation is discussed in more detail in (SG____.67). If combined with (SG____.63), then this may be a way to define an effect for excess bumpers (those that cannot be evenly distributed to players).

(SG____.665) Entangled: Roll four dice; the ship entering the bumper hex becomes “entangled” with another ship for that number of impulses, and the effect may extend into the next turn.

(SG____.6651): The other ship can be selected based on some palpable criteria (closest/furthest, amount by which BPV differs, whatever), or might be chosen randomly (however, a currently “entangled” ship cannot be entangled with another ship).

(SG____.6652): For the purposes of movement, each entangled ship is treated as if it were tractor-linked (G7.3) to the other, but the link cannot be broken by any means. While the entanglement effect does mimic a tractor beam in many ways, there is no actual tractor beam, and use of negative tractor (G7.35) cannot affect the entanglement. If a ship in the entangled pair contacts the Tournament Barrier (SG____.41), it stops (all energy allocated for normal movement during the remainder of the turn is lost) but the entanglement is not broken; this creates a technical exception to (G7.723). An entangled ship stopped by the Barrier may still be eligible to move before the end of the turn using reserve power.

(SG____.6653): Certain movement operations are not affected,

or are affected in specific ways. If an entangled ship executes an HET (C6.0), the other ship also turns, regardless of its eligibility to perform the same maneuver; however, only the ship actually performing the HET must roll for breakdown (C6.5), and if it breaks down then the other ship does not turn and is not damaged in any way. Each ship in the entangled pair may independently use a Quick Reverse (C3.6), Emergency Deceleration (C8.0) and/or Erratic Maneuvering (C10.0) without causing/forcing the other ship in the pair to do the same. An entangled ship may not dock (C13.0), but may recover non-ship units, such as shuttles, normally (Andromedans may also recover satellite ships). While entangled, a ship may not use Tactical Maneuvers (C5.0) if the other ship is not at Speed 0. This bumper effect should not be used with Directed Turn Modes (C3.8).

(SG____.6654): The entangled ships move normally; that is, do not calculate a “pseudo-speed” for the entangled ships. Use the procedure in (G7.36), but ignore **A** and **B**, and use **C** to resolve movement in any impulse where both entangled ships move. If an entangled ship turns (without performing an HET) as part of its movement, the other ship in the pair also turns, even if it has not satisfied its turn mode; the turn modes of both ships in the pair are reset when one turns.

(SG____.6655): An entangled ship may itself be tractored normally by any other ship, except the ship with which it is entangled (as a side-effect, a pair of entangled ships have 999 points of negative tractor, but only with respect to each other; “normal” negative tractor and tractor beams not from the other ship in the pair do not interact with this effect). Use the (G7.36) procedure normally, and combine both the movement costs of, and movement energy allocated by, the entangled ships for **A** and **B** respectively; the entangled pair are treated as a single “ship” with a single pseudo-speed, and the ships of the entangled pair alternate controlling their movement; this rule supercedes the process in (SG____.6654).

(SG____.6656): An entangled ship can only be tractored by one other ship (G7.371), but it is possible to separately tractor each ship in the entangled pair, and this is resolved using (G7.37) normally, treating the entangled pair as a single “ship”, as described in (SG____.6655). However, the same ship cannot tractor both ships in the entangled pair at the same time; if a ship attempts to do so, the second tractor beam (or both if the attempts occur in the same impulse) is automatically broken as if sufficient negative tractor had been generated by the ship or ship (however, this does not require the ship or ships to actually generate negative tractor).

(SG____.6657): Entanglement does not affect any aspect of ship operations except as explicitly described in (SG____.665). Entangled ships may use systems such as electronic warfare, transporters, sensors and scanners without impairment. Weapons, both direct-fire and seeking, are not affected by entanglement of the firing/launching ship. An entangled ship may launch/deploy/land/recover shuttles, mines, probes and

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drogues normally. An entangled ship may launch a Wild Weasel (because entanglement does not involve an actual tractor beam) if otherwise eligible.

(SG____.67) ADVANTAGES: In terms of this scenario, an "advantage" is a persistent and positive effect that is applied to a specific ship for an extended time, rather than a momentary or short-lived (and possibly negative) effect of a bumper hex. An advantage could be almost anything that is permissible within the scope of the SFB tactical combat rules. For the purposes of this scenario, when defining an advantage, there are three main considerations: exactly how the advantage is gained, for how long does it last, and precisely what the advantage does. This sub-section outlines a framework for managing advantages, and discusses a number of possible options concerning them. It is by no means an exhaustive set of rules; if players seek to utilize this sub-section, then due consideration of the actual effects and processes is required.

(SG____.671) Object: One way to bestow an advantage on a ship is by retrieval of an object. Physically, the object will be about one Cargo space in size, inert, transportable with any landing party or aboard a standard shuttle without needing to leave anyone behind, and immune to any attempt to damage or destroy it. The bumper hex contains a small planetoid, or an unmanned and unarmed space-borne base (that cannot be damaged, destroyed or towed). In order to retrieve the object (and thereby gain the advantage), the ship must deploy one (or more) boarding parties (*via* transporter, shuttle, or by a ship capable of landing/docking) to either the GCL of the planetoid or the cargo hold of the base.

(SG____.6711): The landing party must spend at least 32 consecutive impulses, without interference, in order to gain possession of the object. After doing so, the landing party must be retrieved (either *via* transporter, or by the shuttlecraft lifting off and returning to the ship, or by re-boarding the landed/docked ship and leaving the planetoid/base).

(SG____.6712): During the 32 (or whatever) impulses and/or while waiting for retrieval, hostile boarding parties may engage in Boarding Party Combat; (D15.0) or (D16.0), as appropriate. This must be resolved; until then, the combat interrupts the 32 (or whatever) impulse countdown. If the in-process landing force is victorious, then the countdown resumes from when it was interrupted; if the attacking landing party is successful, then it may begin a new count-down. If a landing party has gained the object and is waiting for retrieval, then an attacking landing party, if successful during combat, gains the object without delay (but still must return to their ship).

(SG____.6713): Once brought aboard a ship, the object may be guarded (D7.83) and possibly "stolen" *via* actions such as Hit-and-Run Raids (D7.824); a successful raid transfers the object and advantage. It can be transported to another ship willing to receive it (or even returned to where it was found), and doing so likewise transfers the advantage. If the unit on which the object is located is destroyed, the object instantly returns to its original location and may be subsequently retrieved (unless new objects are constantly created under (SG____.6714), in

which case the object should be lost with the destroyed ship).

(SG____.6714): Optionally, if the intent is to allow multiple ships to gain an advantage (or even advantages) by having an object, then the advantage does not apply until all of the following conditions are met: at least one full Turn after a ship has successfully retrieved the object has elapsed; and, the ship has moved at least eight hexes away from the bumper; and, that separation has been maintained for at least eight impulses. Once those conditions are met, a new object appears at the GCL (or in the cargo hold). It may be retrieved, and will grant an advantage (which may or may not be the same advantage as the previous object).

(SG____.672) Switch: Another way to bestow an advantage on a ship is by a "switch". Again, the ship must visit a small planetoid (or an unarmed, unmanned orbital base that cannot be damaged, destroyed or towed). And, one or more boarding parties are deployed (*via* transporter, shuttle or by a ship capable of landing/docking) to a GCL on the planet (or the cargo hold of the base); after spending 32 (or whatever) consecutive impulses without interference, they are able to "flip the switch".

(SG____.6721): Similar to gaining an object, flipping the switch still requires the landing party to return to the ship (or the ship needs to undock/lift-off) before the ship gains the advantage. The major difference here is that, once gained, the advantage cannot be "stolen" or transferred to another ship merely by a Hit-and-Run Raid.

(SG____.6722): Hostile boarding parties may be able to stop the initial landing party from completing the task, essentially the same (SG____.6712); however, the hostiles can only prevent the enemy ship from gaining the advantage (by stopping the landing party from returning), and would have to follow the same procedure to "flip the switch" once they killed the first landing party.

(SG____.6723): Duration of the advantage is another way that this method varies from (SG____.671). The advantage may be permanent, last until it is used, last for a specific duration, or until a landing party from a different ship manages to "flip the switch". This latter method is closest to "stealing" the advantage as described in (SG____.6713).

(SG____.673) Possible Advantages: There are many advantages that might be gained using either (or both) of (SG____.671) and (SG____.672). This section provides an incomplete list of possible advantages, and suggestions as to how they might work (meaning that the details are left as an exercise to the players, an exercise that must be completed before play starts).

(SG____.6731): Tractor Beam Immunity, Type 1. The ship is immune to tractoring, even if it wants to be tractoried. It is treated as if it always had 100 points of Negative Tractor, at no energy cost.

(SG____.6732): Tractor Beam Immunity, Type 2. Similar to Type 1 (SG____.6731), but the ship can allow a tractor link if it

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wants to. If the advantage was provided by (SG____.672) and the ship allows a tractor link, then the advantage ends.

(SG____.6733): Electronic Warfare, Type 1. The ship is able to do one of the following, for no energy cost: generate three points of ECM, three points of ECCM, or a total of three points of EW usable for either (assigned during the SENSOR LOCK-ON PHASE (4) of each turn the ship has the advantage). The EW points may not be lent.

(SG____.6734): Electronic Warfare, Type 2. The same as Type 1 (SG____.6733), but the ship is able to lend the EW points. The ship having this advantage must be able to lend EW under other rules, or this advantage is treated as Type 1.

(SG____.6735): Bumper Immunity. The ship is immune to the effect of bumpers. This advantage should apply to one of the following: the next bumper the ship enters; or, when declared before the ship enters a bumper. If the advantage was provided by (SG____.672), then it applies to all bumpers the ship enters for some number of turns following the ship gaining the advantage (alternatively, to some small number of bumpers). If the advantage was provided by (SG____.671), then the object vanishes from the ship once it has its effect. The "immunity" means that for the ship a bumper is just another hex, and whatever effect it might otherwise have does not impact the ship; note that this also means that a bumper hex that supplies an "advantage" acts as empty space for the ship (that is, they do not encounter the planetoid/base, even if other ships are in the hex and are doing so, and therefore cannot engage with those other ships on the tactical level - effectively, it cannot find them in the hex). If the bumper is used to score (SG____.69) points, then the points are still scored.

(SG____.6736): The following advantages should generally be bestowed by (SG____.672), and players should consider strict limits on how often any ship can benefit from these:

- Roll one or more dice, multiply the result by the ship's DCR, and repair that many boxes (counting a damaged shuttle as one box)
- The ship is resupplied; one or more of the following: drone storage replenished, PPTs restored, destroyed shuttles replaced, ability to perform CDR and/or EDR restored, mine storage replenished, failed UIM restored to normal operation, destroyed/stolen cloaking device replaced, crew losses replaced
- Suddenly graced with an Outstanding Crew (if the ship already has an Outstanding Crew, then there is no effect)
- Suddenly graced with (random) Legendary Officer (if it already has one or more Legendary Officers, then there is no effect)

(SG____.68) TERRAIN CORRIDORS: After determining the (SG____.412)

terrain around each bumper, use a random method to select one or more "corridors" (hexes of empty space) leading to and/or away from the bumper; units that approach the bumper *via* a corridor avoid the terrain. It is important to decide on a method to establish the number, size and placement of corridors before determining bumper effects.

(SG____.681) Alternatively, a bumper "owner" (SG____.63) might designate corridor(s) for the bumper(s) they "own" (this obviously makes secret bumper ownership difficult, but not impossible); once the corridor(s) have been defined, they should not change, even if the bumper effect changes.

(SG____.682) The corridor(s) for a bumper might have "directionality". That is, when approaching a bumper, a certain set of hexes form the corridor; however, when moving away from the bumper, the corridor might consist of an entirely different set of hexes. While the "approach corridor" should probably be known to all players, it may be interesting to limit knowledge of the "departure corridor" to ships that have reached the bumper. If the corridors are randomly-determined, then another variation might be to make the "departure corridor" unique to each ship that reaches the bumper hex.

(SG____.683) This sub-section merely defines the concept of "corridors", the purpose of which are to allow ships to avoid dealing with the effects of terrain surrounding a given bumper hex. No ship is required to use the corridors (they can instead choose to endure the terrain). While seeking weapons should probably be able to use corridors, that does not permit seeking weapons to violate their movement rules in order to do so (hence, a ship evading seeking weapons might be able to use a corridor to avoid damage from terrain while subjecting seeking weapons to the effects of that same terrain).

(SG____.69) POINTS: Instead of allowing combat, assign point values to each bumper, either randomly, in conjunction with the effect of the bumper, or by some method on which all players agree. No matter how point values are assigned, re-entering the same bumper should not allow a ship to gain points (although the bumper still affects it) unless the ship has first entered a different bumper (this prevents a ship from "running up" its points by bouncing in and out of a single bumper). The first player to score some number of points (by entering bumpers and enduring their effects) wins. It is not recommended to mix this variation with (SG____.663) or (SG____.67).

(SG____.7) TACTICS: There are some obvious general tactics.

(SG____.71) Avoid any bumper that stops (SG____.453) you or puts you in stasis (SG____.454).

(SG____.72) If you plan to enter a bumper that might slow you down – for example, (SG____.456) – make sure you're moving fast enough that you won't be slowed down so much that you stop.

(SG____.73) If you're being chased by a fatal drone wave or mass of plasma torpedoes, try ducking into a bumper hex that will (SG____.452) displace or (SG____.455) teleport you. As a last resort, stasis (SG____.453) could save your life! Those bumpers also break most tractor beams.

(SG____.74) Try to lure seeking weapons into a bumper that (SG____.453) stops them or (SG____.454) places them in stasis. You can also use any terrain around the bumper hexes against seeking weapons.

(SG____.75) Tractor a hostile unit and push/rotate it into a bumper that stops (SG____.453) it or places it into stasis (SG____.454).

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PLAYTESTER COMMENTS: There are no specific tactics for this scenario, which is part of the point. The placement and effects of the bumpers are too dynamic and make pre-planning almost impossible. This is an excellent scenario if you're tired of dodging black holes or fighting monsters.

If you make use of (SG____.67), then all players should carefully consider the mechanism(s) by which any advantage is gained, and the specific effects and/or duration of such advantages; the ideas presented in (SG____.67) are an outline, not a fully-fleshed set of rules, so work out the details before starting play.

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